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Shiny

Fractional CTO for Startups

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Dear Shiny team,

Shiny matches Amsterdam startups with fractional executives who have actually done the work. That framing is right. A seed-stage startup doesn't need a CTO consuming half their runway on retainer. They need someone who can define the architecture, hire the first engineers, set the technical culture, and think alongside the founders for one to two days a week. That's a different role from a full-time CTO, and it deserves its own label.

The honest answer to the title question: I've been the CTO for every organization I've worked with, without the formal title. At Tonomy Foundation I co-founded the company and made every technical decision from stack selection to whitepaper to partner integrations until we reached W3C recognition. At Windesheim University I designed and deployed the entire AI research infrastructure from scratch, solo and self-funded, running it as the single person responsible for architecture, DevOps, and roadmap. As a freelance consultant I delivered technical due diligence on a pre-seed startup that went to a 4x investor exit. At Aeres I recognized a student project worth betting on, became advisor and seed investor, and guided it into an operating agri-tech startup in Slovakia with €2M in funding. In each of these, I was the person founders called when they didn't know what to build next. Fractional CTO is the right label for what I've been doing.

I'm in Baarn (CET), fully remote-capable, and available for one to two day/week engagements. Day rate: €600–€1,200 depending on scope. I work best with early-stage teams that want to ship something real, understand that the architecture decisions made in the first six months shape the next three years, and need someone who holds technical depth and founder-level communication at the same time. Recent domain experience: MICA-compliant digital identity, AI-powered supply chain compliance, blockchain ecosystems, regulated data infrastructure.

If you're matching startups who need technical leadership rather than a traditional CTO hire, I'd like to be in that pool.

Kind regards,

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